

0.0.1 Nandamata

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time, the venerable Sariputta and the venerable Mahamoggallana were wandering on tour with a large community of bhikkhus. Now on that occasion the female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka, having risen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana.
2. At that time the great king Vessavana, was travelling from northern region to the southern region on some business. The great king, Vessavana heard the female lay disciple, Nandamata chanting the Parayana. Having heard, he stood waiting for the chanting to finish. Then the female lay disciple, Nandamata having chanted the Parayana, became silent.
3. So then the great king Vessavana having known that the female disciple, Nandamata had finished, greatly rejoiced saying: “Good sister, good sister.”
4. “But who is this dear?”
5. “I, O sister, am your brother, the great king Vessavana.”
6. Good dear. Well now, may this dhamma discourse chanted by me be my gift to you as my guest.

0.0.1 nandamātu suttaṃ

1. evamme suttaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ āyasmā ca sārīputto āyasmā ca mahāmoggallāno dakkhiṇāgirismiṃ cārikaṃ caranti mahatā bhikkhu saṅghena saddhiṃ. tena kho pana samayena veḷukaṇṭakī nandamātā upāsikā rattiyaṃ paccūsasamayaṃ paccūṭṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sarena bhāsati.

2. tena kho pana samayena vessavaṇo mahārājā uttarāya disāya¹ dakkhiṇaṃ disaṃ gacchati kenacideva karaṇīyena. assosi kho vessavaṇo mahārājā nandamātāya upāsikāya pārāyaṇaṃ sarena bhāsantiyā. sutvā kathāpariyosānaṃ āgamayamāno aṭṭhāsi. atha kho nandamātā upāsikā pārāyaṇaṃ sarena bhāsivā tuṇhī ahosi.

3. atha kho vessavaṇo mahārājā nandamātāya upāsikāya kathāpariyosānaṃ veditvā abbhanumodi: sādhu bhagini, sādhu bhaginīti.

4. ko panaesa bhadramukhāti.

5. ahaṃ te bhaginī bhātā vessavaṇo mahārājāti.

6. sādhu bhadramukha, tena hi yo me ayaṃ dhammapariyāyo bhaṇito, idante hotu ātittheyanti.

¹uttaradisāya - sīmu. ■

7. Very well sister, may this also be your gift to me as your guest. Tomorrow the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana will come to Velukantaka without having eaten their morning meal. Having served that community of bhikkhus, dedicate the offering to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

8. Then with the passing of the night, the female lay disciple, Nandamata prepared excellent hard foods and soft foods at her own house. Then the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana, without having eaten their morning meal, arrived at Velukantaka.

9. So then the female lay disciple, Nandamata addressed a certain man: “Come you good man, having gone to the monastery, announce to the community of bhikkhus: “It is time Bhante, the meal is ready at the house of the noble lady, Nandamata.””

10. Then in the morning, the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana, having dressed, having taken bowl and robe, went to the female lay disciple, Nandamata’s house. Upon arrival, they sat down on a prepared seat.

11. So then the female lay disciple, Nandamata, with her own hands, served and satisfied the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana with excellent hard foods and soft foods. Then, when the venerable

7. sādhu bhaginī, etaṃ ceva me hotu ātitheyyaṃ: sve ca sārīputta moggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso veḷukaṇṭakaṃ āgamissati. tañca bhikkhusaṅghaṃ parivisitvā mama dakkhiṇaṃ ādiseyyāsi. evañca me bhavissati ātitheyyanti.

8. atha kho nandaṃ upāsikā tassā rattiyā accayena sake nivesane paṇītaṃ khādanīyaṃ bhojanīyaṃ paṭiyādāpesi. atha kho sārīputtamoggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso yena veḷukaṇṭako tada-vasarī.

9. atha kho nandaṃ upāsikā aññataraṃ purisaṃ āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ ambho purisa, ārāmaṃ gantvā bhikkhusaṅghassa kālaṃ ārocehi: "kālo bhante, ayyāya nandaṃ upāsikāya nivesane niṭṭhitaṃ bhanta, nti. evaṃ ayye, ti kho so puriso nandaṃ upāsikāya paṭisutvā ārāmaṃ gantvā bhikkhusaṅghassa kālaṃ ārocesi: "kālo bhante, ayyāya nandaṃ upāsikāya nivesane niṭṭhitaṃ bhanta, "

10. atha kho sārīputtamoggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho pubbanhasamayaṃ nivāsetvā pattacīvaraṃ ādāya yena nandaṃ upāsikāya nivesanaṃ tenupasaṅkami. upasaṅkamitvā paṭṭattāsane nisīdi.

11. atha kho nandaṃ upāsikā sārīputtamoggallānapamukhaṃ bhikkhusaṅghaṃ paṇītena khādanīyena bhojanīyena sahatvā santappesi sampavāresi. atha

Sariputta had eaten and removed his hand from the bowl, the female lay disciple, Nandamata, having taken a certain lower seat, sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the venerable Sariputta said this to the female lay disciple, Nandamata.

12. “But who, O Nandamata, announced to you of the community of bhikkhus arrival?”

13. Here I, O Bhante, having arisen during the night before dawn, chanted the Parayana. Then, O Bhante, the great king Vessavana having known that I had finished, greatly rejoiced saying: “Good sister, good sister.”

14. “But who is this dear?”

15. “I, O sister, am your brother, the great king Vessavana.”

16. Good dear. Well now, may this dhamma discourse chanted by me be my gift to you as my guest.

17. Very well sister, may this also be your gift to me as your guest. Tomorrow the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana will come to Velukantaka without having eaten their morning meal. Having served that community of bhikkhus, dedicate the offering to me. Thus, that will be your gift to me as your guest.

kho nandamātā upāsikā āyasmantaṃ sārīputtaṃ bhut-tāviṃ onītapattapāṇiṃ ekamantaṃ nisīdi. ekamantaṃ nisinnaṃ kho nandamātaraṃ upāsikaṃ āyasmā sārīputto etadavoca:

12. ko pana te nandamāte, bhikkhusaṅghassa abbhā-gamaṇaṃ ārocesīti.

13. idhāhaṃ bhante, rattiyaṃ paccusasamayaṃ pac-cuṭṭhāya pārāyaṇaṃ sarena bhāsivā tuṇhī ahosiṃ. atha kho bhante, vessavaṇo mahārājā mama kathāpariyo-sānaṃ viditvā abbhanumodi "sādhū bhaginī, sādhū bhaginī, ti.

14. ko panesa bhadramukhāti.

15. ahaṃ te bhaginī bhātā vessavaṇo mahārājāti.

16. sādhū bhadramukha, tena hi yo me ayaṃ dham-mapariyāyo bhaṇito, idante hotu ātittheyyanti.

17. sādhū bhaginī, etaṃ ceva me hotu ātittheyyaṃ: sve ca sārīputta moggallānapamukho bhikkhusaṅgho akatapātarāso veḷukaṇṭakaṃ āgamissati. tañca bhik-khusaṅghaṃ parivisitvā mama dakkhiṇaṃ ādiseyyāsi. evañca me bhavissati ātittheyyanti.

18. That is to say, O Bhante, “May the merits of this offering indeed be for the happiness of that great king Vessavana.”

19. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you converse face to face with the great king by the name of Vessavana, the son of the devas who is so powerful, of such great influence.”

20. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

21. Here, O Bhante, my only son named Nanda, dearly and beloved, the king having siezed him on some pretext or another, dragged him away and killed him. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind when the young boy was siezed or while being siezed; when he was bounded or while being bounded; when he was slain or while being slain.

22. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

23. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

18. yadidaṃ bhante, dāne puññaṃ hi taṃ² vessavaṇṇassa mahārājassa sukhāya hotuti.

19. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma vessavaṇṇena mahārājena evaṃ mahiddhikena evaṃ mahesakkhena devaputtena sammukhā sallapissatīti.

20. na kho me bhante esova³ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

21. idha me bhante nando nāma⁴ eko puttako piyo manāpo. taṃ rājāno kismiñcideva pakaraṇe okkassa paggayha jīvitā voropesuṃ. tasmim kho panāhaṃ bhante, dārake gahite vā gayhamāne vā baddhe vā vajjhamāne vā hate vā haṭṭamāne vā nābhijānāmi cittassa añña-thattanti.

22. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, yatra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

23. na kho me bhante esova⁵ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo. atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

²puññaṃ puññamahīti - machasaṃ, puññamaham - pts; puññamahitaṃ - syā

³eseva - machasaṃ

⁴nandako nāma - simu

⁵eseva - machasaṃ

24. Here, O Bhante, when my husband passed away, he arose in a certain womb of a yakkha. He revealed himself to me with just his former self-begotten. Yet I, O Bhante, do not recall an alteration of mind on account of that.

25. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

27. “From the time, O Bhante, that I was brought to my young husband as a young girl, I do not recall transgressing against my husband even in thought, let alone in body.”

28. “It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata, in as much as you purify even the arousal of mental states.”

26. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

24. idha me bhante, sāmiko kālakato assa aññata-
raṃ yakkhayoniṃ upapanno⁶. so me teneva purimena
attabhāvena uddasseti. na kho panāhaṃ bhante, abhi-
jānāmi tato nidānaṃ cittassa aññathattanti.

25. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, ya-
tra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

26. na kho me bhante esova⁷ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

27. yatohaṃ bhante, sāmikassa daharasseva daharā
ānītā, nābhijānāmi sāmikaṃ manasāpi aticaritā, kuto
pana kāyenāti.

28. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhūtaṃ nandamāte, ya-
tra hi nāma cittuppādampi parisodhessatīti.

26. na kho me bhante esova⁸ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

30. yadāhaṃ bhante, upāsikā paṭidesitā, nābhijānāmi
kiñci sikkhāpadaṃ sañcicca vitikkamitāti.

31. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamāteti.

⁶yakkhayoniyaṃ uppanno - simu

⁷eseva - machasaṃ

⁸eseva - machasaṃ

30. “Since I, O Bhante, declared myself a female lay disciple, I do not recall purposely transgressing any training rules.”

31. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

32. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

33. Here O Bhante, to whatever extent I wish, quite secluded from sense-desires, secluded from unwholesome dhammas, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of seclusion, connected with thinking and pondering, the first jhana. From the subsiding of thinking and pondering, with the internal tranquilization and unification of mind, without thinking and pondering, I enter upon and abide in the happiness and pleasure born of samadhi, the second jhana. With the fading away of happiness, I, dwelling mindful and contemplative, look on with equanimity as I experience pleasure in the body, of which the Noble Ones say: “The equanimous dweller in pleasure is the mindful one,” I enter upon and abide in the third jhana. From the abandoning of [physical] pleasure and pain, from the extinction of former mental pleasure and mental pain, I enter upon and abide in the utter purity of mindfulness and equanimity, without pain, without pleasure, the fourth jhana.

32. na kho me bhante esova⁹ acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

33. idhāhaṃ bhante, yāvadeva¹⁰ ākaṅkhāmi vivicceva
kāmehi vivicca akusalehi dhammehi savitakkaṃ savi-
cāraṃ vicekajāṃ pītisukhaṃ paṭhamāṃ jhānaṃ upa-
sampajja viharāmi. vitakkavicārānaṃ vūpasamā aj-
jhattaṃ sampasādanaṃ cetaso ekodibhāvaṃ avitak-
kaṃ avicāraṃ samādhijāṃ¹¹ pītisukhaṃ dutiyaṃ jhā-
naṃ upasampajja viharāmi. pītiyā ca virāgā upekkhakā
ca viharāmi, satā ca sampajānā sukhañca kāyena pa-
ṭisaṃvedemi. yaṃ taṃ ariyā ācikkhantī upekkhako
satimā sukhavihāriti tatiyaṃ jhanaṃ upasampajja vi-
harāmi. sukhassa ca pahānā dukkhassa ca pahānā
pubbeva somanassadomanassānaṃ atthagamā aduk-
khaṃ asukhaṃ upekkhāsatipārisuddhiṃ catutthaṃ jhā-
naṃ upasampajja viharāmi.

34. acchariyaṃ nandamāte, abbhutaṃ nandamāteti.

35. na kho me bhante esova¹² acchariyo abbhuto dhammo.
atthi me aññopi acchariyo abbhuto dhammo:

36. yānīmāni bhante, bhagavatā desitāni pañcoram-
bhāgiyāni saññojanāni, nāhaṃ tesāṃ kiñci attani ap-

⁹eseva - machasaṃ

¹⁰yāvade - machasaṃ

¹¹vivekajāṃ machasaṃ

¹²eseva - machasaṃ

34. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

35. That is not, O Bhante, the only marvellous and unprecedented quality of mine. There are for me also other marvellous and unprecedented qualities.

36. Of these five lower fetters declared by the Auspicious One, O Bhante, I do not see any of them that are not abandoned in myself.

37. It is marvellous, O Nandamata, it is unprecedented, O Nandamata.”

38. Then the venerable Sariputta having further instructed, aroused, energized and gladdened the female lay disciple, Nandamata with talk on the Dhamma, having risen up from his seat, he departed.

pahīnaṃ samanupassāmi.

37. acchariyaṃ nandaṃāte, abbhutaṃ nandaṃātetī.

38. atha kho āyasmā sārīputto nandaṃātaraṃ upāsi-
kaṃ dhammiyā kathāya sandassetvā samādapetvā sa-
muttejetvā sampahaṃsetvā uṭṭhāyāsanaṃ pakkāmiti.